GLASSHOUSE

TENUOUS TRUCE

It was a picture-perfect occasion, Kerala's warring Congress leaders—PCC chief **K. Sudhakaran**, leader of the opposition V.D. Satheeshan and MPs **Shashi Tharoor** and K. Muraleedharan among others—lining up at the border in Parassala to receive the **Rahul Gandhi**-led Bharat Jodo Yatra as it entered the state on September 11. But the truce lasted just hours. Sudhakaran and Tharoor waited in vain for Rahul to arrive to inaugurate a Congress freedom fighter's memorial at NIMS Medicity. The Gandhi scion couldn't make it due to security reasons and both leaders were livid with the yatra organisers for their "insensitivity". Muraleedharan, meanwhile, boycotted a function for Rahul at Nemom, after he was denied entry to the dais. Whether the Congress yatra unites India or not, it has clearly failed to unite partymen in Kerala.

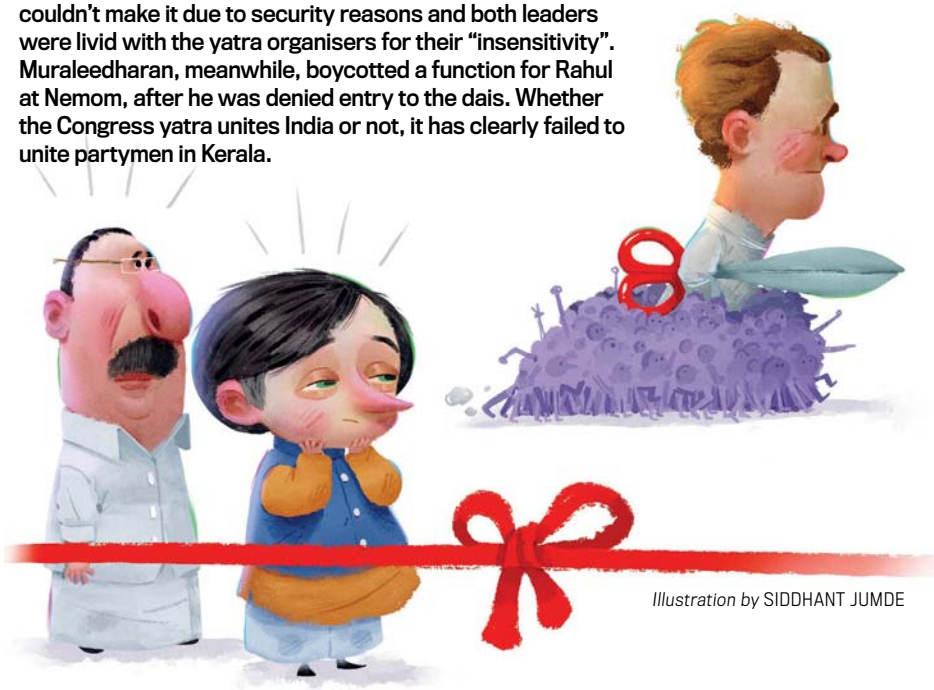


Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

Total Recall

It's the 114th birth anniversary of Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) leader **C.N. Annadurai**, the first CM of Tamil Nadu, and rival All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (AIADMK) has announced a week-long celebration. The AIADMK was named after the Dravidian movement icon by party founder, the late M.G. Ramachandran, when he broke away in 1972. The 'Anna' initiative is current party chief **E.K. Palaniswami**'s bid to infuse some Dravidian pride among the cadre. Atheist Annadurai, though, would have loathed the fact that EPS made the gesture right after visiting Tirumala temple on September 9.



ANI

THE CYCLING SPY

A health-conscious Congress MLA is the talk of the town in Guwahati. Every evening, the legislator takes a round of the quarters where ministers and MLAs stay on his bicycle. While he claims it is to keep his weight in check, many say he is a spy of Assam CM **Himanta Biswa Sarma**, keeping an eye on who was visiting whom. When confronted about his frequent visits to the BJP CM's home, the Muslim MLA, an ally of Sarma during his Congress days, told his party it was for "constituency-related issues".



Kaushik Deka with Jeemon Jacob, Amitabh Srivastava and Amarnath K. Menon



GHAR WAPSI?

First, they took Odisha away from **Daggubati Purandeswari**, the third daughter of the late N.T. Rama Rao, founder of Telugu Desam Party (TDP). On September 9, they relieved the 63-year-old of her responsibilities as party in-charge in Chhattisgarh too. Sources say the party's hopes for her didn't pan out either in Andhra Pradesh or her assigned states. Rumour now has it that she may be mending ties with TDP and ex-CM N. Chandrababu Naidu who has been trying to reunite the first family in a bid to keep alive NTR's legacy.

Sympathy or Sarcasm?

Ever since he stormed out of the NDA in August, Bihar CM **Nitish Kumar** seems ever ready to take on the BJP central leadership. He still seems to have a soft corner for the party's leaders in Bihar though. Nitish has in the past questioned why Sushil Modi was denied responsibility at the Centre, and now he's taken up the cause of another of his ex-deputy CMs, Tara Kishore Prasad. The BJP has overlooked Prasad while picking ex-assembly speaker Vijay Sinha as leader of the Opposition. Divide and rule, or is the CM's heart still beating for his former deputies?



RANJAN RAHI